The Morning Letter

With the compliments of the Editor, to Jonesboro, Brookland & neighbors

Saturday, the Fourteenth of November, 2026

Good morning,

Modern gun deer season opens this morning on a hard frost, about 31 degrees at daybreak, with sunshine all day and a high near 53, the start of a dry week that warms into the 70s by Friday. Downtown, the Craighead County Veterans Day Parade steps off at 10. In the news: a Brookland man is sentenced to 12 years in federal prison, the city changes how it posts council records, a nationwide ground stop snarled air travel Friday, Arkansas says it will not delay its Medicaid work requirement, and President Trump plans a first three-way meeting with the leaders of China and Russia. The Red Wolves play at Coastal Carolina at noon, and the Razorbacks host No. 17 South Carolina tonight.

The Day Ahead

Today	6 AM	9 AM	12 PM	3 PM	6 PM	9 PM
Temperature	31°	41°	50°	53°	42°	37°
Sky	☀	☀	☀	☀	☁	☁
Rain	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%

	Sat 14	Sun 15	Mon 16	Tue 17	Wed 18	Thu 19	Fri 20
High / Low	**53°** / 31°	**57°** / 34°	**60°** / 33°	**62°** / 36°	**67°** / 43°	**68°** / 48°	**73°** / —
Morning	☀ 41° · 0%	☁ 42° · 0%	☀ 46° · 0%	☀ 46° · 0%	☀ 50° · 0%	☁ 55° · 3%	☁ 59° · 9%
Midday	☀ 50° · 0%	☁ 54° · 0%	☀ 57° · 0%	☀ 59° · 0%	☀ 63° · 0%	☁ 65° · 3%	☀ 70° · 7%
Afternoon	☀ 53° · 0%	☁ 57° · 0%	☀ 60° · 0%	☀ 62° · 0%	☀ 66° · 0%	☁ 68° · 3%	☀ 72° · 7%
Rain, day	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	3%	9%

A hard frost to begin the weekend: it is about 31 degrees at 6 a.m. under a clear sky, and the sun does its work slowly, bringing 41 by 9 o'clock, 50 at noon and a high near 53 in mid-afternoon, with no chance of rain at any hour. The sun is down by five; it is back to 42 by 6 p.m. and 37 by 9, with a few clouds drifting in overnight toward a low near 34.

The week ahead is a slow, dry thaw. Sunday reaches 57 under mostly sunny skies, Monday 60 after a frosty start near 33, and Tuesday 62; by Wednesday the afternoon climbs to 67 and the nights turn mild, in the 40s. Thursday and Friday bring the first small rain chances, only 3 and 9 percent, with Friday's high near 73. Anyone with leaves to burn should note that a dry, sunny stretch also dries the woods; check the county's burn status before striking a match.

The Almanac

First light	**6:10 AM**	Sunrise	**6:38 AM**
Solar noon	**11:47 AM**	Sunset	**4:55 PM**
Last light	**5:23 PM**	Length of day	**10 h 17 m**
Change from yesterday	**−1 m 41 s**	Moon	**Waxing Crescent, 21% lit**

The young moon, a thin crescent about a fifth lit, follows the sun down in the southwest and sets a little after 9 p.m., leaving the rest of the night to the stars; it reaches first quarter around Tuesday and full around the 24th. The day is now 10 hours and 17 minutes, a minute and 41 seconds shorter than Friday's, and sunset has settled just before five o'clock, and it will creep only a few minutes earlier before turning back in December.

Mid-November is pecan time: the nuts are dropping in old yards and along the fencerows, and a dry week is the best kind for gathering them before the squirrels and crows finish the job. Persimmons on the wild trees at the woods' edge have turned soft and orange-brown, and the old rule holds that a frost or two takes the pucker out of them. Over the flat Delta fields east of the Ridge, the harvested rice and bean ground lies open, and the first big flights of snow geese and ducks are coming down out of the north ahead of next Saturday's duck opener.

In the garden, there is still time to set out tulip and daffodil bulbs, which want the cold to come; plant them about three times as deep as the bulb is tall. Fallen oak and maple leaves are better shredded into the beds or the compost pile than bagged for the curb. On this date in 1851 an American publisher brought out Herman Melville's *Moby-Dick*, the whaling novel that sold poorly in its author's lifetime and is now counted among the great American books.

Weather lore, not a forecast: “If there's ice in November that will bear a duck, there'll be nothing after but sludge and muck.” This week's warming trend will keep the ponds open, whatever the old saying may make of it.

Of Local Interest

Brookland man gets 12 years in federal prison for selling methamphetamine

A 56-year-old Brookland man, Rickey Allen Brown, was sentenced Thursday to 12 years in federal prison for distributing methamphetamine and possessing it with intent to sell. U.S. District Judge D.P. Marshall Jr. also ordered five years of supervised release once he is out; there is no parole in the federal system. Brown had pleaded guilty on May 2, 2025, the same day prosecutors filed the charges against him.

According to the case, in December 2021 an informant working with investigators bought two bags of methamphetamine from Brown at his Brookland home for $700, and a federal drug lab found the drug was 100% pure. In January 2022, officers stopped Brown after watching him leave a suspected drug house and found two bags in his pocket and nearly 110 grams under the driver’s seat. His record includes earlier convictions for making methamphetamine, stalking, domestic battery, assault and terroristic threatening.

The FBI led the investigation with the Second Judicial Drug Task Force (a regional narcotics unit), the Craighead County Sheriff’s Office and Arkansas State Police.

Jonesboro changes how it posts agendas and records council votes

The City of Jonesboro is moving its public meeting records and its in-meeting voting system to a new company, CivicPlus. Agendas, minutes, documents and meeting videos for the City Council and its committees, the Metropolitan Area Planning Commission (the board that reviews zoning and development) and the Board of Zoning Adjustments have lived on a service called Legistar, which residents had called cumbersome and outdated.

City Clerk April Leggett said the city had looked for alternatives for several years because it was not getting the customer support it needed, and the old SHURE voting system in the council chambers was aging and could no longer be supported. Chief Administrative Officer Brian Richardson said the switch also helps the city meet disability-access rules for its website. Leggett called the change "budget neutral," with the biggest cost, new microphones and tablets for members and speakers, paid from the information technology budget.

Documents for upcoming meetings are already being posted on the new portal, jonesboroar.portal.civicclerk.com, and moving the old records over should take one to two weeks. Until then, past records stay searchable on Legistar, whose contract runs through the end of 2026. Residents who need help can call the clerk's office at 870-935-0305 or visit the first floor of the Municipal Center, 300 S. Church St., weekdays 8 a.m. to 5 p.m.

KASU asks listeners for $60,000 this weekend

KASU 91.9 FM, the public radio station run by Arkansas State University, is in the middle of a live fall fundraising weekend aimed at raising $60,000. The station says the money is needed to make up for the end of federal support for public media. On-air fundraising runs today, Saturday, from 9 a.m. to 3 p.m., and Sunday from 9:30 a.m. to 10 p.m.

The weekend closes with a free "Records Party" for listeners from 4 to 7 p.m. Sunday at the KASU studios, Room 152 of the Education/Communication Building on the A-State campus, during a live two-hour broadcast of the music show *6 Degrees of the Delta*. Arkansas musician Greg Spradlin will co-host with LaDawn Fuhr and play live in the studio. Listeners who call in between noon and 3 p.m. Sunday can win a quilt sewn from donated KASU T-shirts by student reporter Lexie Burns.

Station manager Mark Smith said KASU is carrying on with support from the university, listeners and business underwriters. KASU signed on May 17, 1957, and is the oldest noncommercial public radio station in Arkansas. Gifts can be made at kasu.org/give or through the KASU app.

Police make arrests in several Jonesboro assault and threat cases

Jonesboro police and Craighead County judges handled a run of violent-crime cases this week; each charge is an accusation, not a finding of guilt. Cody Tyler Singleton, 38, of Jonesboro, is charged with first-degree terroristic threatening, a felony, after a woman told police that on Nov. 3 a man loitering in a parking lot in the 1800 block of East Highland Drive threatened to shoot her while reaching into his pockets. Detectives used video to identify him and arrested him Nov. 12 on East Nettleton Avenue; his bond is $60,000, and he is due in circuit court Jan. 25.

Leon Mead is charged with aggravated assault on a family or household member after police said he backed up and sped toward his girlfriend in the 1600 block of Stone Street on Nov. 11; she jumped in front of a parked car to avoid being hit, and a witness backed up her account. He is held on $65,000 bond and due in court Dec. 16. Arthur Isiaah Buggs, 27, of Jonesboro, is charged with false imprisonment and aggravated assault after a woman told police Nov. 12 that he choked her and blocked her from leaving their home for about 20 minutes; his bond is $40,000, and he is also due in court Dec. 16.

Alexis Ellisen is charged with second-degree battery and criminal mischief after police said she struck a woman in the face with a bat through an open car window on Nov. 10 and damaged the car; she was released Friday on $30,000 bond and is due in court Jan. 25. Separately, detectives are asking the public to help identify two women accused of taking credit cards from a vehicle and using them on a shopping trip at Lowe's; anyone who recognizes them can call Detective Morgan at 870-935-6710, and a cash reward is possible.

Single parents in Craighead County win college scholarships

The Arkansas Single Parent Scholarship Fund, a nonprofit that helps low-income single parents finish college or job training, has awarded $121,200 this fall to 88 single parents in Northeast Arkansas, including 46 from Craighead County. The awards of up to $1,600 cover costs that can stand in the way of a degree or trade certificate, and they come with mentoring, money-management lessons and career coaching.

A family endowment, the Ernest and Anna Ritter Family Endowment, paid for 25 of the scholarships, totaling $32,000, for students from Poinsett, Craighead and Mississippi counties. Recipients were honored at ceremonies Oct. 18 at St. Bernards Auditorium in Jonesboro and Oct. 20 at Arkansas Northeastern College in Blytheville. Mokebia Calicutt, a Craighead County mother attending Arkansas State University-Newport, said the help eased the strain of balancing classes, work and raising her son.

The fund has given more than $55 million to single parents across Arkansas since 1990. Program manager Carrie Allen can be reached at 870-345-4681.

Art fair will raise money for a Jonesboro artist's kidney transplant

Local artists, makers and musicians will hold a community art fair and fundraiser on Saturday, Nov. 21, from 3 to 8 p.m. for Lindsay Ainsworth, a Jonesboro artist and recent Arkansas State University graphic design graduate who needs a second kidney transplant. Ainsworth has lived with end-stage kidney disease for nearly 16 years; her first transplant lasted about 13 years. Her cousin, Tiffany Brackenrich, will be her living donor.

Visitors can shop original art and handmade clothing, try creative activities, watch artists at work and hear music from Mark Currey and Justin Castro of the Jonesboro band Delta Bruise; prizes will be awarded around 7:30 p.m. A silent auction of artwork, classes and experiences opens for online bidding at midnight Sunday, Nov. 15. Money raised will help pay for travel to Vanderbilt's transplant center in Nashville, living costs while she cannot work, and recovery costs for both women. The Bradbury Art Museum, Northeast Arkansas Visual Artists and the American Advertising Federation of Northeast Arkansas are among the partners.

Around town

Saturday, 8 a.m.–1 p.m.: Main Street from Strawn to Huntington avenues and Church Street from Matthews to Strawn avenues are closed downtown for the Craighead County Veterans Day Parade, which steps off at 10 a.m.; free. **Saturday, 9 a.m.–2 p.m.:** The Judd Hill Farmers Market opens the first of three winter markets on Aggie Road, with local vendors, an ornament-decorating station, holiday passports and door prizes; shoppers who come to all three markets (Nov. 14, Nov. 21 and Dec. 19) can enter a drawing for a $400 gift certificate. **Sunday, 4–7 p.m.:** KASU's free Records Party with musician Greg Spradlin, Room 152, Education/Communication Building, A-State campus. **Monday, Nov. 16, 7 p.m.:** The Northeast Arkansas Chorale's Christmas concert, "The Arrival," at Manley Chapel, Williams Baptist University, Walnut Ridge; $10, $20 family cap. **Tuesday, Nov. 17, 6–7:30 p.m.:** IMPACT Arkansas, a University of Arkansas program that prepares teachers to become principals, holds roundtables and a question-and-answer session for educators at the Crowley's Ridge

Education Service Cooperative, 1606 Pine Grove Lane, Harrisburg; food provided. **Saturday, Nov. 21, 3–8 p.m.:** Community art fair benefiting Lindsay Ainsworth. **Wednesday, Dec. 9, 4–8 p.m.:** The Junior Auxiliary of Jonesboro's free Coats & Cocoa giveaway, one coat per child while supplies last, at the Parker Park Community Center gym, 1506 N. Church St.; new or gently used coats can be dropped off at Harris Furniture or NYC Sugaring by Dec. 7.

Our neighbors farther afield

Blytheville: Arkansas State Police are investigating the death of Edgar Andrew Guyton, 39, of Blytheville, who died after being taken to the Mississippi County Detention Center following his arrest Tuesday, Nov. 10. Police said jail staff found suspected fentanyl hidden on him, that he became combative and tried to swallow it, and that the packaging broke in his mouth before he lost consciousness. Staff gave him the overdose-reversal drug Narcan and CPR, but he was pronounced dead at a hospital in Osceola. The State Crime Laboratory will determine the cause and manner of death.

From the Police Reports

Jonesboro Police incident reports. Charges are allegations. No names are printed.

The department filed 33 reports covering Thursday and early Friday, with 11 people arrested or cited.

Overnight: A driver was arrested on a felony DWI charge, plus refusal to submit to a chemical test, no ignition interlock, no insurance, hazardous driving and an open container, after allegedly backing into a parked car in a lot on Old Greensboro Road about 1 a.m. Friday. A fight on North Church Street drew a third-degree battery report, and a worker's phone was reported stolen at a pharmacy on Southwest Drive.

Hit-and-runs: Drivers left the scene of four crashes: at Highland and Conveyor, at Old Greensboro Road and Peachtree Avenue, at East Nettleton Avenue and Tony Drive, and at King Street and Red Wolf Boulevard earlier in the week. If you are struck, note the other vehicle's color, make and direction and call police right away.

Fraud and theft: A business on Orval Orlan Drive reported more than $5,000 in garage door openers bought with a fraudulent card, a felony theft. Checks and debit cards taken from a vehicle on Gilmore Drive were later used (felony fraudulent card use). A storage unit on East Whitman Street was broken into and antique toys taken (felony breaking or entering).

Thursday: An ATM at a bank on East Johnson Avenue was damaged, and a vehicle's windows were broken out on West Jefferson Avenue, both criminal mischief.

Domestic cases, 72401 area: Three people were arrested: one on felony first-degree false imprisonment and aggravated assault on a family or household member, one on felony second-degree domestic battering, and one on third-degree domestic battery. A fourth report was filed without an arrest.

Routine: Three people were arrested or cited on unpaid-fines warrants, one also for failure to appear; others were cited for probation revocation near Bryan and East Highland, marijuana possession at South Gee and West Washington, and no insurance after a parking-lot crash. Also: a domestic battery arrest, juvenile victim; and a report of a vape given to a juvenile.

At the county jails

Craighead County: the county jail roster showed 309 people held early Saturday, 33 of them booked in the last 48 hours; among the newest bookings listed first, the charges ran mostly to parole and probation violations, small-amount marijuana possession and failure to obey court orders, with one domestic-battery and one DWI arrest, and the highest bond shown was $40,000 on an aggravated-assault charge involving a family member. **Randolph County:** the roster at Pocahontas showed 62 held, with four new bookings since Thursday morning, including a felony charge of fleeing police in a vehicle and causing serious injury, a second-offense DWI and a drug-possession count; seven people were released in the last 48 hours. Being on a roster is not a conviction.

From the State

Arkansas turns down a federal offer to delay its Medicaid work requirement

Arkansas will begin enforcing a work requirement for many adults on Medicaid on Jan. 1, even though federal officials said Friday that states may hold off on enforcement until June 30. The Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services, the federal agency that oversees Medicaid, offered the six-month delay to give states time to "improve and refine their systems." A spokesman for the Arkansas Department of Human Services said the state is "prepared to implement" the requirement on schedule.

The rule applies to ARHOME, the state's Medicaid expansion program, which covered about 209,000 low-income Arkansans ages 19 to 64 as of Nov. 1. Many of them will have to log 80 hours a month of work, school or volunteering, a condition set by the federal tax-and-spending law Congress passed last year. Pregnant women, parents and caregivers of children under 14, the medically frail, veterans rated totally disabled and several other groups are exempt. In July, almost 64,000 enrollees were told they were "not compliant" during a trial run that carried no penalties.

Arkansas tried a similar requirement in 2018; a federal judge struck it down after thousands lost coverage. The state's human services department says it will check records such as income, work hours and disability status to decide who complies. The Legislature, which convenes Jan. 11, will also have to settle on a long-term replacement for ARHOME, whose federal approval was extended only six months.

State Library Board reverses itself and reopens library rules for comment

The Arkansas State Library Board on Friday voted to send its proposed rules on "sexually explicit" library materials back out for public comment, hours after it had unanimously approved them. The rules would carry out Act 372 of 2023, a state law meant to keep minors from obtaining books and films with nudity or sexual content in public libraries that receive state aid. The law also makes knowingly giving a "harmful" item to a minor a misdemeanor punishable by up to a year in jail.

After librarians objected that the draft could sweep in educational works, the board voted 3-2 to exempt encyclopedias and fine art, which one member defined as certain art created before 1900. Under the draft, covered material would be placed in adult-only areas, children under 16 would need a parent's permission to check it out, and libraries could offer puberty information to children over 11 with written parental consent. A federal appeals court in July lifted an order that had blocked the law. The new comment period's dates were not announced; the rules would then go to the Legislature.

Texarkana weighs selling Millwood Lake water to North Texas

Texarkana and neighboring Southwest Arkansas towns are pursuing a 40-year deal to lease up to 110 million gallons a day of water rights from Millwood Lake, a reservoir on the Little River, to the North Texas Municipal Water District, a utility serving the Dallas area. About 70 residents questioned city

and water officials at a meeting Thursday. A private company would build a roughly $2 billion, 72-inch pipeline, and the participating communities could earn more than $20 million a year.

Texarkana's city manager said Arkansas' water needs "will always come first," noting the city uses about 7 million gallons a day and would keep about 40 million. Residents raised concerns about droughts and endangered species; officials said the deal includes provisions to cut or suspend transfers in low water, though no separate environmental impact study has been done. The Arkansas Natural Resources Commission, which oversees state water resources, is expected to take up the application at a hearing Nov. 18, and the Legislature would have the final say, possibly in March or April.

University of Arkansas review of Razorback athletics sets goals but no plan

A review of University of Arkansas athletics, ordered by the UA System Board of Trustees in September after the Razorback football team's third losing season in four years, produced broad goals but no concrete plan when it was presented Friday. UA System President Jay Silveria, who leaves in January to become president of Purdue University, outlined five "pillars," mainly raising revenue, improving name, image and likeness (NIL) pay opportunities for athletes, strengthening donor support and ranking in the top half of the Southeastern Conference in athletic spending.

The written report stated that "no action plans nor next steps were identified." Board Chairman Randy Lawson said spending alone does not guarantee wins and urged university leaders to keep the effort going after Silveria departs.

From the Nation

Nationwide ground stop halts U.S. flights for hours; thousands canceled

The Federal Aviation Administration, which runs the nation's air traffic control system, stopped all departing flights across the United States for more than four hours Friday afternoon after what it called a "temporary telecommunications outage." The problem disrupted communications at the regional centers that guide planes between airports. The ground stop began in mid-afternoon and was lifted that evening; planes already in the air were allowed to land.

Cancellations approached 5,000 by Friday night, and delays were expected to spill into the weekend. At Little Rock's airport, at least 20 departures were delayed or canceled, and some passengers waited hours aboard parked planes. The last comparable nationwide shutdown was in January 2023, when an FAA safety-messaging system failed.

Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy said network switches and routers became overloaded with data and went down, but added, "We're still working on the details of what went wrong today." Homeland Security Secretary Markwayne Mullin said there was no indication of a cyberattack and no link to this week's Microsoft outage or to a new AI-based FAA planning tool, while not ruling anything out; he said officials are examining whether older equipment clashed with newer technology being installed. Sen. Tammy Duckworth, an Illinois Democrat, called for a full investigation.

United States reportedly loses its measles elimination status

The United States has lost the "measles eliminated" status it has held since 2000, according to reports Friday that an independent expert panel advising the Pan American Health Organization, the World Health Organization's regional office for the Americas, made the determination. A country loses the status when the same strain of measles spreads continuously for more than a year. A Utah lab study found one strain caused more than 95% of that state's cases from June 2025 to June 2026.

More than 5,400 measles cases have been reported nationally this year, the most since 1991, nearly all in people who were unvaccinated or whose status was unknown. Pennsylvania and Wisconsin each reported a new measles-related death Friday, bringing state-reported deaths this year to at least 10; the federal count is lower, after Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. asked the CDC not to count disputed deaths. Canada lost its status last year. Losing it carries no automatic penalty, but health experts say regaining it will be difficult as kindergarten vaccination rates have fallen to 92.4%. *(Based on reports citing a person familiar with the decision; no formal announcement from the health organization yet.)*

Supreme Court will decide whether Trump can shut off asylum at the border

The Supreme Court agreed Friday to decide whether President Trump had the power to suspend asylum at the southern border. On his first day back in office in January 2025, Trump issued a proclamation declaring an "invasion" at the border and barring migrants who cross between ports of entry from seeking asylum, the legal protection for people who fear persecution at home. A federal judge in Washington ruled in July 2025 that neither the Constitution nor immigration law gave him that authority, and a divided appeals court largely agreed in April.

The justices will also decide whether the lower court could protect all asylum seekers rather than only those who sued. The administration argues the policy is its main tool against illegal crossings and says border encounters have dropped 93% since it took effect; immigrant advocates say it violates laws passed by Congress. The policy remains largely in force while the case proceeds. Arguments are expected in the spring, with a ruling by early summer.

Washington widens its look at Nvidia after its chief executive resigns

Congress is moving to question Jensen Huang, who resigned Thursday as chief executive of Nvidia, the computer-chip maker at the center of the artificial intelligence boom, after reports that he had a relationship with a business executive whom U.S. officials reportedly suspect of spying for China. The woman worked for a Singapore company accused of smuggling restricted Nvidia chips into China. Chief Financial Officer Colette Kress is serving as interim chief executive.

Sen. Tim Scott of South Carolina, the Republican chairman of the Senate Banking Committee, on Thursday asked Huang to testify Dec. 3 and Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick on Dec. 10, threatening subpoenas if they refuse. Lutnick, whose department enforces chip export limits, has been criticized over reports that it was slow to act against firms routing chips to China; a Commerce spokeswoman said he agreed to appear voluntarily, and the White House has backed him. Three House committee chairmen have also sought testimony from Huang and Nvidia's top lawyer. Democrats, who take control of both chambers in January, say they will continue the inquiries.

Senate Democrats' leadership fight takes shape

Sen. Chris Van Hollen of Maryland is formally challenging Sen. Chuck Schumer of New York, the Senate's top Democrat since 2017, for the job of leading the party when Democrats take the Senate majority in January. Van Hollen, who announced Thursday, says the party needs new leadership after the midterm elections and has criticized Schumer for taking sides in Democratic primaries. On Friday, Sen. Jeff Merkley of Oregon became the first sitting senator to publicly endorse him.

Schumer says he has the votes to keep his post, and public endorsements so far favor him by a wide margin; the secret-ballot vote is set for Dec. 1. Separately, Democrat Cindy Holscher was declared the winner of the Kansas governor's race over Republican Ty Masterson, keeping the office in Democratic

hands. Some newly elected Democrats are also openly pitching health-care deals to President Trump, while others, such as Virginia Gov. Abigail Spanberger, say the party should pass its own bills and dare him to veto them.

From Abroad

Trump, Xi and Putin plan first three-way meeting next week in China

The White House said Friday that President Trump will meet China's President Xi Jinping and Russia's President Vladimir Putin together next week in Shenzhen, China, on the sidelines of the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation summit, a yearly gathering of Pacific Rim leaders. It would be the first meeting of the three leaders together. A U.S. official said Trump wants to discuss cutting nuclear weapons and the war with Iran, but not the war in Ukraine.

The talks come after New START, the last treaty capping U.S. and Russian nuclear arsenals, expired in February, leaving no limits on either country's weapons for the first time in more than 50 years; Trump wants any new deal to include China. A senior administration official said, "We do not expect to get to any kind of agreement." Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov called the meeting "extremely significant," while Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelensky has voiced concern that his country's future could be discussed without Ukraine present.

Iran escalates in the Strait of Hormuz as Trump says no deal is needed

Iran said Saturday that more oil tankers struck naval mines and caught fire in the eastern Strait of Hormuz, the narrow passage linking the Persian Gulf to the open sea and a key route for the world's oil. Iran says ships need its permission to pass and warned that any tanker using what it calls a restricted route "will be set on fire." Iran's claims could not be independently verified; the U.S. military says it has cleared the main shipping lanes and that the strait is open. A senior U.N. official said Friday that at least 25 sailors have been killed in and around the strait since the U.S.-Israeli war with Iran began in February, and shipping there is about 65% below prewar levels.

On Friday, the U.S. military said it shot down two Iranian attack drones headed for Bahrain, the island kingdom that hosts the U.S. Navy's Fifth Fleet, and denied an Iranian Revolutionary Guard claim that it destroyed a U.S. radar there. Iran also told the International Atomic Energy Agency, the U.N. nuclear watchdog, that talks on inspections cannot proceed while it faces military threats.

The fighting follows President Trump's announcement Thursday that "we don't need a deal" with Iran, as he removed Vice President JD Vance from leading negotiations and assigned him to investigate fraud in Democratic-run states. Trump later said it would be a "defeat" to leave Iran's current government in power, and officials would not say whether talks have stopped.

Europe names five nations to join Ukraine peace talks; Moscow noncommittal

European Union leaders meeting in Dublin, Ireland, decided Friday that Britain, France, Germany, Italy and Poland, together with EU officials, will represent Europe in the next round of U.S.-brokered talks to end Russia's war in Ukraine. The step follows a visit to Moscow this week by U.S. envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner, who said afterward that Putin was "willing to give it a try" with European participation. Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky welcomed the move, saying it would give Europe "a voice."

The Kremlin said no decision had been made; Russia has opposed direct European involvement because European countries arm Ukraine. European Council President Antonio Costa said Europe "must speak with one clear voice." No date or location has been set for the next round. Zelensky also said a recently

agreed prisoner exchange would be the largest of the war.

International Criminal Court drops inquiry into U.S. troops in Afghanistan

Judges at the International Criminal Court, the world's permanent war-crimes tribunal in The Hague, have halted the investigation into alleged crimes by American troops and intelligence officers in Afghanistan, narrowing the case to the Taliban's conduct since it retook power in 2021. The ruling, issued Thursday and made public Friday, cited "significant limitations" on prosecutors' ability to gather evidence. The U.S. portion of the inquiry had been largely dormant since 2021.

The prosecutor's office said it has already appealed. The United States is not a member of the court and has sanctioned 13 current and former court staff over this inquiry and over arrest warrants for Israeli officials. Secretary of State Marco Rubio has said Trump "will never allow" the court to prosecute Americans.

Markets & the Farm

Figures are as of Friday's close, November 13. Week changes are from Friday, November 6.

Index	Close	Day	Week
S&P 500	7,561.67	−0.40%	+2.51%
Dow Jones industrials	52,347.55	+0.10%	+2.07%
Nasdaq composite	25,136.27	−0.91%	+2.27%

Stocks slipped Friday as Nvidia's leadership turmoil after Jensen Huang's exit kept pressure on chipmakers, and a hotter-than-hoped 6.5% yearly rise in wholesale prices left traders all but certain the Fed will raise rates at its Dec. 9 meeting; the Dow still edged up, and all three indexes posted their best week since early August.

Next week brings Home Depot and Nvidia results on Tuesday, Target and Lowe's on Wednesday, Walmart on Thursday, plus remarks Monday from Fed Chair Kevin Warsh.

What analysts are saying

- **Analysts leaned toward buying: PANW** (Palo Alto Networks, a cybersecurity software maker). KeyBanc raised the stock to overweight from sector weight, betting company security budgets will speed up through 2027 and calling the recent dip a buying chance. Risk: the shares gave back an early gain to close about flat, and budgets could grow more slowly than KeyBanc expects.
- **Analysts leaned toward buying: DPZ** (Domino's Pizza, the delivery and carryout pizza chain). Baird upgraded the shares to outperform from neutral, seeing a clearer path to better same-store sales and fatter franchisee profits. Risk: a stretched consumer facing higher interest rates could cut back on takeout.
- **Analysts leaned toward buying: ECL** (Ecolab, which sells cleaning, sanitation and water-treatment products to businesses). Wells Fargo raised it to overweight from equal weight, expecting the company's pricing surcharge to stick. Risk: customers could push back on the extra charges if costs ease.
- **Analysts turned cautious: LOW** (Lowe's, the home-improvement retailer). Stifel cut the stock to sell from hold, with analyst Andrew Carter pointing to a weaker housing market, margin pressure ahead and soft do-it-yourself demand. Risk to the bearish view: Lowe's reports Wednesday, and a better-than-feared quarter could lift the shares.

- **Analysts turned cautious: AVGO** (Broadcom, a maker of networking and custom AI chips). Rothschild & Co Redburn lowered it to neutral from buy, seeing limited near-term upside and concerns about Google's in-house custom chip tools. Risk to that view: Wolfe Research reiterated its outperform rating the same day, citing strong AI demand.

This is information, not advice.

Commodities

Commodity	Close	Change
WTI crude (Dec.)	$88.56	−$0.18
Brent crude (Jan.)	$95.84	+$0.02
Arkansas avg. regular gas (AAA, Nov. 12)	$3.55	−16¢ on week
Jonesboro avg. regular gas (AAA, Nov. 12)	$3.48	−15¢ on week
Live cattle (Dec.)	$220.65	+$1.75
Feeder cattle (Jan.)	$335.35	+$3.67½
Lean hogs (Dec.)	$55.45	+30¢
Corn (Dec.)	$4.45½	+3¢
Soybeans (Jan.)	$12.31½	+12½¢
Chicago wheat (Dec.)	$5.93¼	+9¢
Cotton (Dec.)	78.78¢/lb	+0.11¢
Rough rice (Jan.)	$18.39/cwt	−26½¢

Commodities as of Friday's close. Cotton and the rough-rice change: single source (Brownfield). Gasoline: AAA Arkansas, Nov. 12, single outlet (KAIT).

On the Field

Arkansas State football (4–5, 2–3 Sun Belt) kicks off at noon Central at Coastal Carolina (3–6, 2–3) on ESPN+, from Brooks Stadium in Conway, S.C. Both teams are trying to bounce back. The Red Wolves lost 19–17 to ULM last week, and the Chanticleers fell 21–8 to Old Dominion. Quarterback Trey Owens threw for 193 yards and ran for 67 against ULM. Coastal, a slight favorite of about a point and a half, will start redshirt freshman Deuce Bailey on its Senior Day and is trying to end a four-game losing streak at home. A-State needs two more wins to become bowl-eligible.

A-State men's basketball (1–2) has lost two straight since opening with a 71–70 win over Toledo: 101–86 at Alabama and 82–65 at home to UT Martin on Tuesday. They host Dillard tonight at 7 at First National Bank Arena (ESPN+) and UAPB on Wednesday at 7, then head to Miami for the FIU Thanksgiving tournament Nov. 23–25.

Arkansas (3–6, 1–5 SEC) faces No. 17 South Carolina (6–3, 4–3) at 6:45 p.m. on SEC Network in Fayetteville. The Razorbacks are in the spoiler's role and have lost 10 straight SEC home games. The Gamecocks have won four in a row, and quarterback LaNorris Sellers was upgraded to probable Thursday after playing on a sore ankle. It is first-year Hog coach Ryan Silverfield's first meeting with Shane Beamer, and South Carolina's offensive coordinator is former Arkansas OC Kendal Briles. Arkansas leads the series 14–10, and South Carolina is favored by about a touchdown.

Tennessee (7–2, 4–2 SEC), No. 8 in the CFP rankings, plays at Texas A&M (4–5, 1–5) at 2 p.m. on ESPN at Kyle Field. The Vols lead the nation with 39 sacks and allow 15.1 points a game. Running back DeSean Bishop has 1,066 rushing yards, 426 shy of the school's single-season record. Tennessee is favored by about 2½ points over an Aggie team that has lost three straight SEC games, and LSU visits Knoxville next week.

Afield & Afloat

Ratings are rule-of-thumb estimates from the forecast, the rut calendar and the sun, not measurements of animal or fish behavior.

Deer outlook: Good

Opening morning of modern gun season comes with nearly everything in the hunter's favor: the rut is at or near its peak in north Arkansas, the dawn is below freezing, the barometer has climbed behind the front, and the wind is light. Best windows: from about 6:08 a.m., a half hour before sunrise, until about 8:40; again from 10 a.m. to 2 p.m., when rutting bucks cruise in daylight looking for does; and from 2:55 p.m. to the 4:55 sunset.

Today's tip: on a still, frosty dawn your scent sinks and creeps downhill, pooling in the hollows and creek bottoms, so sit above the trails you are watching rather than below them; once the sun warms the slopes by mid-morning the air turns and rises. With more than 300,000 hunters expected afield this weekend, wear the required blaze orange from the truck to the stand, and know what lies beyond your target before you squeeze.

Tomorrow, Sunday (estimate: Good). Another cold, near-calm dawn and steady high pressure, with the rut still in full swing; the same windows apply, from 6:09 a.m., 10 to 2, and 2:55 to sunset. **Tomorrow's tip:** after a day of opening-weekend gunfire, older deer slip into the thickest cover they know, cutovers, briar patches and creek-bottom cane, and bucks trailing does keep moving through midday; a patient hunter on the edge of that cover, staying put through lunch, often does better on Sunday than on Saturday.

Fishing outlook: Fair

Lake water is cooling fast after the frosty nights, and the bite is slow early, but the light breeze and a sunny afternoon near 53 should stir the fish in the warmer hours. Best times: late morning through mid-afternoon as the water warms, and the last hour before the 4:55 sunset.

Today's tip: at Craighead Forest Lake and Lake Frierson, crappie are drawing together on brush piles and around fishing piers and docks, often 8 to 15 feet down; fish a small minnow or a 1/16-ounce jig slowly, just above the cover. Bass will move to the sunny north banks by afternoon, where rocks and wood soak up warmth; a slow-rolled crankbait or a jig dragged along the bottom beats fast, flashy lures in cold water.

Tomorrow, Sunday (estimate: Fair). Another frosty start and light wind, with a slightly warmer afternoon near 57; the best hours again run from late morning to mid-afternoon and the last hour of light. **Tomorrow's tip:** catfish feed through the cool months in the deeper water near the dam and old creek channels; a piece of cut shad or chicken liver on the bottom, fished patiently through the warm part of the afternoon, is the surest bet for a Sunday stringer.

In season now, and what is next (zones 3, 4, 6 and 8)

Zone	Archery	Youth gun	Modern gun	Muzzleloader
3	open to Feb. 28	Jan. 2–3	Nov. 14–Dec. 6; Dec. 26–28	Dec. 12–14
4	open to Feb. 28	Jan. 2–3	Nov. 14–22; Dec. 26–28	no season
6	open to Feb. 28	Jan. 2–3	Nov. 14–Dec. 6; Dec. 26–28	Dec. 12–14
8	open to Feb. 28	Jan. 2–3	Nov. 14–Dec. 6; Dec. 26–28	Dec. 12–14

Modern gun season opens this morning in all four zones. In Zone 4, which takes in Craighead County, it runs only nine days, through next Sunday, Nov. 22, and allows just one antlerless deer by modern gun; in Zones 3, 6 and 8 it runs to Dec. 6. All four zones reopen Dec. 26–28, and Zones 3, 6 and 8 have a muzzleloader hunt Dec. 12–14. The season bag is four deer, no more than two of them bucks, and chronic wasting disease rules on carcass movement apply in Craighead County; check agfc.com for check-in rules and the zone's details before you go.

Ducks open a week from today, Saturday, Nov. 21, for a first segment through Nov. 29, followed by Dec. 10–23 and Dec. 26 through Jan. 31; the daily limit is six, with no more than four mallards, two of them hens. Canada geese run with the duck segments, two a day; white-fronted geese are two a day; snow, blue and Ross's geese, 20. The youth, veteran and active-military waterfowl hunt is Feb. 6–7. Quail are open through Feb. 7, six a day.

Postscript

Yet one smile more, departing, distant sun!
One mellow smile through the soft vapoury air,
Ere, o’er the frozen earth, the loud winds run,
Or snows are sifted o’er the meadows bare.
One smile on the brown hills and naked trees,
And the dark rocks whose summer wreaths are cast,
And the blue gentian flower, that, in the breeze,
Nods lonely, of her beauteous race the last.
Yet a few sunny days, in which the bee
Shall murmur by the hedge that skirts the way,
The cricket chirp upon the russet lea,
And man delight to linger in thy ray.
Yet one rich smile, and we will try to bear
The piercing winter frost, and winds, and darkened air.

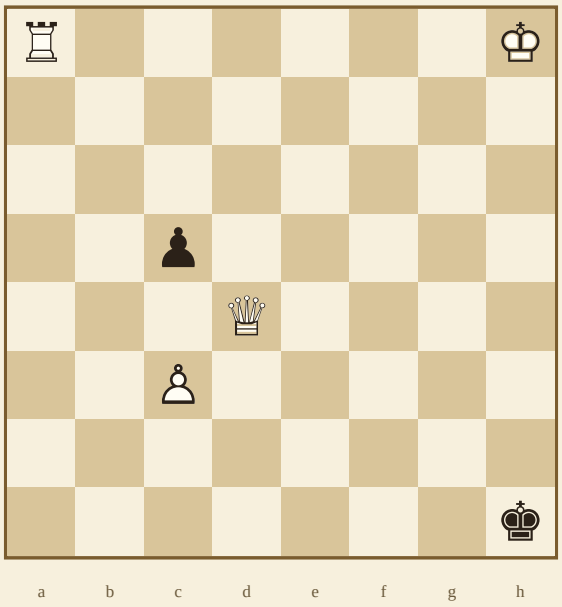
— William Cullen Bryant, “November” (1824). A week of sunny days lies ahead before the first real chill of winter; the poet would tell us to linger in them.

Until tomorrow, with good wishes —
The Editor

Compiled from many reports.

The Pastimes

I. Mate in Two



White to move and checkmate in two moves, against any defence. White is shown with the lighter, outlined pieces; the board is oriented with White at the bottom.

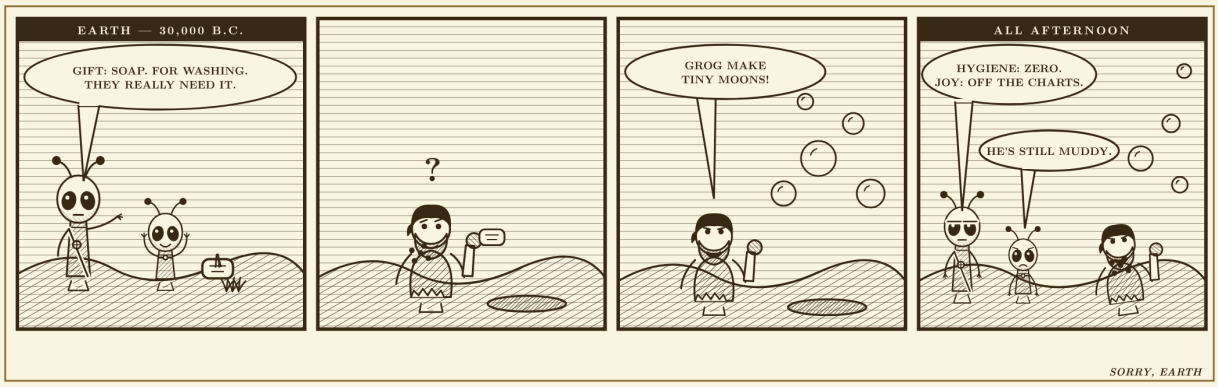
II. Word Fleet

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J
1	G	E	N	E	R	O	U	S	J	B
2	K	D	S	E	A	J	N	J	K	H
3	K	R	E	R	P	F	K	E	H	A
4	N	O	P	D	H	E	B	W	P	U
5	E	B	B	S	B	B	H	I	K	G
6	F	U	U	J	R	I	L	T	R	H
7	H	S	A	T	C	J	E	T	B	T
8	J	T	F	C	K	L	R	Y	L	Y
9	I	W	K	I	E	E	A	W	C	D
10	U	S	T	U	B	B	O	R	N	H

1. _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (8) Ready to give more of your money, time or help than is expected
2. _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (7) Proud in a cold, superior way; looking down on others
3. _ _ _ _ _ _ (6) Strong and healthy; built to hold up under hard use
4. _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _ (8) Unwilling to change your mind or give way, even when you should
5. _ _ _ _ _ (5) Quick and clever with words in an amusing way

Each clue is a definition. Find its word in the grid, across or down. Fire by putting a pencil dot on a letter: one dot is one shot. Check the answers below, then circle each right letter and cross out each wrong one. Your score is your number of dots. ***Best possible score: 34 shots.*** *My shots:* _____

III. Sorry, Earth



Solutions printed upside down.

I. Key move: Qd2. Then Kg1 Ra1#, c4 Ra1#.
II. GENEROUS A1 across, HAUGHTY J2 down, ROBUST B3 down, STUBBORN B10 across, WITTY H4 down